



Games record of 149kg in the snatch. Having led after the opening discipline, he ultimately came up short in the clean and jerk, finishing with a total of 330kg to Hidayat's Games-record 331kg.

The disappointments of Nirupama Devi (women's 63kg) and Sanjana (women's 77kg), who both ended with 'Did Not Finish' (DNF), along with Martina Devi Maimbam's fifth-place finish in the +86kg category, added to the gloom within the weightlifting camp.

Raja Muthupandi's silver came with a modest total of 286kg, well below the standard he had shown in recent competitions.

Despite fielding a depleted contingent because of a reduced quota, India entered lifters in only 11 of the 16 weight categories and still emerged with eight medals.

The men competed in four of the eight weight categories — 60kg, 65kg, 79kg and +110kg — and won medals in all four. Rishikanta Singh (60kg), Raja (65kg), Ajaya (79kg) and Lovepreet (+110kg) all claimed silver medals.

The women's campaign, however, presented a mixed picture. India fielded lifters in seven of the eight weight categories and won medals in four of them. Mirabai Chanu once again lived up to expectations, winning gold in the 48kg class for the third successive

Commonwealth Games.

Mirabai was head and shoulders above the competition in the 48kg category. Her dominance was evident as she set a Commonwealth and Games record in the snatch with 85kg, a Games record in the clean and jerk with 105kg, and a Games record in the total with 190kg.

Gyaneshwari Yadav added to the tally with silver in the women's 53kg category. She remained in control throughout the competition before finishing behind Nigeria's lifter.

India, however, returned empty-handed in the women's 63kg, 77kg and +86kg categories.

Yet there was a lingering feeling that the tally could have been richer, with Ajaya and Lovepreet both finishing just one kilogram short of gold. While the eight medals represented a drop from the 10 won at Birmingham in 2022, winning medals in eight of the 11 categories it contested underlined India's enduring strength in weightlifting, one of the country's most reliable medal-producing sports. Although the field was not as strong as at the Asian Games or Olympics, it remained competitive enough to test the Indians across several weight categories.

India's joy doubled when its judokas claimed a historic two gold medals through Asmita Dey (48kg)

Historic feat: India's first-ever Commonwealth Games gold in judo came from Asmita Dey, a five-foot judoka from the North-Eastern state of Tripura. GETTY IMAGES

and Harsh Singh (60kg), taking the sport's overall medal haul to four.

Glasgow was a memorable Games for India. A fourth-place finish in the medal standings and sustained medal contention across disciplines reflected the country's growing competitiveness, even as shortcomings in a few events offered valuable lessons for the future.

» INDIA MEDALS TALLY

GOLD 13

SILVER 17

BRONZE 9

TOTAL 39